

The four required nodes are:

1. **Manual Trigger:** starts the workflow.
2. **Read/Write Files from Disk:** reads the document from the computer that runs n8n.
3. **Extract from File:** turns the file into plain text.
4. **Basic LLM Chain:** sends the text and your questions to an AI model, with rules to answer only from the document. The chain needs a chat model attached to it (a sub-node) to work.

Test Document:

Sunrise Tech - Employee Leave Policy (Sample)

1. Casual leave: Employees get 12 days of casual leave per year.
2. Sick leave: Employees get 8 days of sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for more than 2 consecutive days.
3. Notice: Casual leave must be applied for at least 2 working days in advance.
4. Carry forward: Up to 5 unused casual leave days can be carried forward to the next year.
5. Approval: Leave requests are approved by the reporting manager.

Step 1: Create a new workflow

5. In n8n, click Create workflow (or the + button) to open a blank canvas.
6. Click the name at the top and rename it to Document QA Agent.

Step 2: Add the Manual Trigger

1. Click Add first step (or the + on the canvas).
2. Search for Manual Trigger and select it. Newer versions may already place it on the canvas as "When clicking Test workflow". No settings are needed.

Step 3: Add Read/Write Files from Disk

1. Click the + after the trigger, search for Read/Write Files from Disk, and choose the action Read File(s) From Disk.
2. In File(s) Selector, type the full path to your document, for example /home/node/.n8n-files/leave_policy.txt or C:\Users\YourName\.n8n-files\leave_policy.txt.
3. Leave the options as they are. By default the file is placed in a binary field called data.
4. Click Execute step. In the Output panel, open the Binary tab and confirm you see a field called data with your file name.

Step 4: Add Extract from File

1. Click the + after the file node and search for Extract from File.
2. In Operation, choose the type that matches your file: Extract From Text File for .txt, or Extract From PDF for .pdf. (Word .docx files are not supported, so save them as PDF first.)
3. Keep Input Binary Field as data (it must match the name you saw in Step 3).

4. Click Execute step and open the output in the JSON view. For a PDF, the text is in a field called text.

Watch the field name: For Extract From Text File, the text goes into the Destination Output Field, which defaults to data. Change it to text so the prompt below works as written. If you keep data, use {{ \$json.data }} in the prompt instead.

Step 5: Add the Basic LLM Chain

1. Click the + after Extract from File, search for Basic LLM Chain, and add it.
2. Set Source for Prompt (User Message) to Define below.
3. In the Prompt field, paste the text below. Switch the field to Expression mode (hover over the field and choose Expression) so that {{ \$json.text }} is replaced by the document text.

```
Document content:
""
{{ $json.text }}
""
```

Questions:

1. How many casual leave days do employees get per year?
2. When is a medical certificate required?
3. What is the work-from-home policy?

1. In the same node, click Add Prompt (under Chat Messages), choose the type System, and paste the system message below.

```
You are a document question-answering assistant. Answer ONLY
using the document content provided by the user. Do not use outside
knowledge and do not guess. If the user asks several questions,
answer each one separately and number the answers to match. If the
answer to a question is not found in the document, reply for that
question exactly: "I could not find this information in the
uploaded document." Keep answers short and, where helpful, mention
the part of the document the answer comes from.
```

Step 6: Attach the chat model

1. On the Basic LLM Chain node, click the + under Model (the connector marked with a red asterisk).
2. Choose your model node (OpenAI Chat Model, Groq Chat Model or Google Gemini Chat Model).
3. Click Credential, choose Create new credential, paste your API key and save.
4. Select a model from the Model dropdown. Under Options, add Sampling Temperature (or Temperature) and set it to 0 so answers stay close to the document.

Step 7: Run and read the answers

1. Click Execute workflow at the bottom of the canvas.
2. Open the Basic LLM Chain node and read the answer in the Output panel (field text).
3. To ask different questions, edit the Questions part of the prompt and run again. You can ask several questions in one run by numbering them.

Output:

